

New Ground: A Signal

新的起点：一个信号

Theme: 大学生活与个人成长 · New: 45 · Review: 0 · Planned cumulative progress: 45/6, 127

English Story

Three months **ago**, Lin Wei had imagined university as a quiet place where success would **depend** on private effort. Yet on a bright **autumn** morning, he stood outside Harbor City University's registration hall with a **cell phone** in one hand and a paper map in the other. The university had **recently** released an orientation **app**, but it kept sending students to a locked door. **Latently**, Lin had tried to appear calm and **youthful**. Now he watched a **creative** crowd invent its own directions.

“Good **lord**, there are **plenty** of maps, but none of them agree,” said Maya Chen, who was eating a **noodle** from a paper cup. A visitor nearby waved an unlit **cigar** and complained that the **smoggy** air made every building look alike. On one map, a **grassy** path crossed land marked for **drought** research; on another, the same path ended beside a **tidal** laboratory. The campus signs did little to **illustrate** which route was open.

Then the registration kiosk **broke**. Its screen **automatically** moved **upward** through a list of error messages, including one called “address **normalization**.” A **picky** administrator told everyone to **conform** to the printed instructions. Maya gave an **exclamatory** reply—“How?”—and asked Lin to **summarize** the problem. In language class, an **infinitive** might be easy to identify; in a crowd, “to register” was harder to **achieve**. Lin used the maps to **illustrate** the contradiction instead of arguing about blame.

A volunteer stretched a **rope** across the unsafe path, and the line of students moved **steadily** toward the wrong building. Some looked **helpless**. Lin expected Maya to **brag** about finding the error first, but she was **supportive**. Together they made a simple sign, then added photographs to the **app**. Each clear image could **strengthen** one instruction and **reinforce** the next. Their correction worked with surprising **rapidity**.

The old maps were **theirs** to criticize, but the new solution would be **theirs** to maintain. Near a wall of **remembrance**, under a **starry** design painted by former students, Maya said that a useful system should **inspire** confidence rather than reward the people who **excel** at guessing. Lin admitted that silence would have been **cowardice**. A **boastful** solution could not **dignify** its users, and technology alone could not **civilize** an institution. Their first design had to be adaptive: it should learn from mistakes, purify bad data, and respect people who needed help. That small decision became the beginning of their shared project.

中文翻译

三个月前，林伟曾把大学想象成一个安静的地方，成功全靠个人努力。然而在一个明亮的秋日早晨，他站在港城大学注册大厅外，一手拿着手机，一手拿着纸质地图。学校最近发布了一款迎新应用，但它不断把学生引向一扇上锁的门。最近林伟一直努力显得镇定而有朝气，此刻却看到一群富有创意的人各自发明路线。

“天哪，地图多得很，却没有两张说法一致。”陈曼雅一边从纸杯里夹起一根面条一边说。一位访客挥着一支没有点燃的雪茄，抱怨烟雾弥漫的空气让所有建筑看起来都一样。一张地图上的草地小路穿过标为干旱研究区的土地；另一张地图却让同一条路终止在潮汐实验室旁。校园标识完全没有说明哪条路可以通行。

随后注册终端坏了。屏幕自动向上滚动一串错误信息，其中一项叫作“地址规范化”。一名挑剔的管理员让所有人遵照纸质说明。曼雅用感叹的语气反问：“怎么遵照？”并请林伟概括问题。在语言课上，辨认不定式也许很容易；但在人群中，“去注册”却很难实现。林伟用几张地图说明矛盾，没有争论该怪谁。

一名志愿者用绳子拦住危险小路，学生队伍却稳定地向错误的大楼移动，有些人显得无助。林伟以为曼雅会吹嘘自己最先发现错误，但她非常支持他。他们一起做了一块简易指示牌，又在应用里加入照片。每张清晰图片都能加强一条说明，并巩固下一条。修正以惊人的速度奏效。

旧地图是前辈们制作的，他们可以批评；新方案则属于他们，也要由他们维护。在一面纪念墙旁、历届学生绘制的星空图案下，曼雅说，一个有用的系统应当激发信心，而不是只奖励擅长猜测的人。林伟承认，保持沉默会是一种怯懦。自夸的方案不能赋予使用者尊严，技术本身也不能使机构文明。第一次设计必须具有适应性：从错误中学习、清除坏数据，并尊重需要帮助的人。这个小决定成了他们共同项目的起点。

Core Vocabulary · 核心词汇

Word / Pronunciation	Context meaning / source example
ago ə'geu POS: adv	adv. 以前 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: s. gone by; or in the past; r. in the past
achieve ə'tʃi:v POS: vt	vt. 完成, 达到; vi. 如愿以偿 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: v. to gain with effort
lord lɔ:d POS: n	n. 统治者, 阁下, 上帝; vi. 称王, 作威作福; vt. 使成贵族 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a titled peer of the realm; v. make a lord of someone
recently 'ri:sntli POS: adv	adv. 最近 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: r. in the recent past
depend di'pend POS: vi	vi. 靠, 视...而定, 信赖 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: v. be contingent upon (something that is elided)
illustrate 'iləstreit POS: vt	vt. 举例说明, 作图解, 阐明; vi. 举例说明 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: v. depict with an illustration; v. supply with illustrations
plenty 'plenti POS: n	n. 充分, 很多, 丰富; a. 很多的, 足够的, 丰富的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a full supply
creative kri:'eitiv POS: a	a. 有创造力的, 创作的, 产生的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: a. having the ability or power to create; s. promoting construction or creation
autumn 'ɔ:təm POS: n	n. 秋天, 成熟期 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n the season when the leaves fall from the trees
inspire in'spaɪə POS: vt	vt. 使感动, 激发, 启示, 吸入, 鼓舞, 产生, 使生灵感; vi. 吸入, 赋予灵感 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: v. heighten or intensify; v. supply the inspiration for
strengthen 'streŋθən POS: vt	vt. 加强, 变坚固; vi. 变强, 股票上涨 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: v. make strong or stronger; v. gain strength
automatically ,ɔ:tə'mætikli POS: adv	adv. 自动地, 机械地 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: r. in a reflex manner
reinforce ,ri:in'fɔ:s POS: vt	vt. 加强, 增援, 补充; vi. 求援, 得到增援; n. 加固材料 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: v. make stronger; v. strengthen and support with rewards
rope reup POS: n	n. 绳, 索, 粗绳, 绞索, 诀窍; vt. 捆, 缚, 绑, 圈起, 以绳将...系住; vi. 拧成绳状 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a strong line; v. fasten with a rope
steadily 'stedili POS: adv	adv. 稳定地, 无变化地, 有规则地 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: r. at a steady rate or pace; r. in a steady manner
lately 'leitli POS: adv	adv. 近来, 最近 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: r in the recent past
supportive sə'pɔ:tiv POS: a	a. 支撑, 支承, 资助, 赞助, 支援, 经受, 忍受, 扶养, 证实, 鼓励, 维持, 伴奏 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: a. furnishing support or assistance
conform kən'fɔ:m POS: vt	vt. 使一致, 使遵守, 使符合; vi. 一致, 符合, 适应 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: v. be similar, be in line with
drought draut POS: n	n. 干旱, 缺乏 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a shortage of rainfall; n. a prolonged shortage
theirs ðeəz POS: pron	pron. 他们的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: No reliable source example available.
summarize 'sʌməraɪz POS: v	v. 概述, 总结 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: v. be a summary of
cigar si'ga: POS: n	n. 雪茄 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a roll of tobacco for smoking
upward 'ʌpwəd POS: a	a. 向上的; adv. 以上 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: s. directed up
helpless 'helplis POS: a	a. 无助的, 无能为力的, 无依无靠的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: s. lacking in or deprived of strength or power; s. unable to function; without help; s. unable to manage indepe...
infinitive in'finitiv POS: n	n. 不定式; a. 不定式的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the uninflected form of the verb

Word / Pronunciation	Context meaning / source example
excel ik'sel POS: vt	vt. 胜过, 优于, 擅长; vi. 胜过其他 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: v. distinguish oneself
youthful 'ju:θful POS: a	a. 年轻的, 青年的; [法] 青年的, 年轻的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: s. suggestive of youth; vigorous and fresh
noodle 'nu:dl POS: n	n. 面条, 笨蛋 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a ribbonlike strip of pasta
brag bræg POS: n	n. 吹牛; v. 吹牛 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. an instance of boastful talk
tidal 'taidl POS: a	a. 潮汐的, 受潮汐影响的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: a. of or relating to or caused by tides
grassy 'græsi POS: a	a. 草绿色的, 象草的, 长满草的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: a. abounding in grass
broke brəuk POS: a	a. 一文不名的; break的过去式 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: s. lacking funds
remembrance ri'membrəns POS: n	n. 回想, 记忆, 纪念品, 记忆力, 问候, 致意 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the ability to recall past occurrences
starry 'sta:ri POS: a	a. 星光照耀的, 多星的, 星形的, 明亮的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: a. abounding with or resembling stars
normalization .nɔ:məlaɪ'zeɪʃən POS: n	n. 常态化, 正常化, 正规化; [化] 归一化; 正态化; 正火; 正火处理 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n the imposition of standards or regulations
picky 'piki POS: a	a. 吹毛求疵的, 挑剔的, 找麻烦的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: s exacting especially about details
app phonetic unavailable POS: review required	[计] 应用, 应用程序; 相联并行处理器 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: No reliable source example available.
cowardice 'kauədɪs POS: n	n. 懦弱 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the trait of lacking courage
rapidity rə'pɪdɪti POS: n	n. 迅速, 急速, 速度 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n a rate that is rapid
dignify 'dɪgnɪfaɪ POS: vt	vt. 增威严, 使高贵, 故作显贵 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: v. raise the status of
boastful 'bəʊstful POS: a	a. 自夸的, 自负的, 喜夸耀的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: s. exhibiting self-importance
civilize 'sɪvɪlaɪz POS: vt	vt. 使开化, 使文明; vi. 变文明 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: v. raise from a barbaric to a civilized state
smoggy 'smɒ'ʒi, 'smɔ:- POS: a	a. 烟雾弥漫的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: s. clouded with a mixture of smoke and fog
exclamatory ik'sklæmətəri POS: a	a. 感叹的, 惊叹的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: s sudden and strong
cell phone sel feʊn POS: n	n. 手机 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: No reliable source example available.